

Design-Intent Document

Read this first

Your design-intent doc gives the judges the **facts** they need to assess your prototype: what it is, how to play it, and what is in the build.

Describe your game plainly. Do not try to sell it. This document is **not scored** and is not judged on writing quality. This is the context that helps a judge play your prototype properly and give it a fair read.

The rules for the file:

- **File format:** Microsoft Word **.docx** (if using GDocs, only **.docx** exports will be accepted, no PDFs or **.txts**).
- **Length: 500 words maximum.** Keep it short and factual. Do not pad.
- **Text only.** No images, screenshots, diagrams, charts or tables. Describe things in words.
- **Use the sections below exactly as given.** Do not rename, reorder, merge or add sections. Leave a heading in even if your answer is short.
- **Do not include your name, your handle, or other identifying information.**

You may delete all the instructions above the linebreak in this doc and all italicized notes within each section to allow for additional space. Those are just prompts to get you started.

1. Game title and genre

Your game's title and the single competition genre it belongs to. One line.

[Your answer here]

2. Target player and pitch

Who is this game for, and what is it, in two or three sentences? What kind of player enjoys it, and what do they want out of a session?

[Your answer here]

3. How to play (controls)

How does a player actually operate your prototype? List the controls and the basic steps to start playing, for example: tap to place, drag to move, button to start a wave. A judge should be able to pick it up and play in under a minute.

[Your answer here]

4. Core loop

The most important section. What does the player do over and over, and why is it satisfying? Cover: the primary action or actions; the goal and the win / lose / reset state, or for an open-ended game the clear session goal; the feedback that tells the player they are doing well or badly; and why the loop is fun to repeat.

[Your answer here]

5. What is in this prototype

Exactly what your submitted build contains. Be specific about what is implemented and playable versus what is not yet in. This tells judges what they are evaluating. Bullets are fine.

[Your answer here]

6. Progression and signature twist

How the experience develops within a single play session: difficulty ramp, growth, unlocks, escalation. Judges play one sitting, so describe what they will actually see. If your game has one distinctive mechanic you most want to validate, name it. Write "N/A" if none.

[Your answer here]

7. Future-state vision

If you win the grant and rebuild this into a real game using the early access creation tools, what does the full game become? One or two sentences.

[Your answer here]